Mandates

A mandate check has three answers, not two.

Within, outside, and the one that's easy to leave out: not evaluable.



HalvorAI

Source of truth

We never ask you to type in a limit.

Limits retyped into a monitoring tool drift from the real ones.

In AP2 and Mastercard Verifiable Intent, a mandate is a signed credential. We read it from the evidence on the payment.

One vocabulary

Two formats, one set of constraints.

Constraint	Checked against
amount_range	the payment amount
budget	sum of settled payments
recurrence	count and spacing
allowed_payees	payee id, name or website
allowed_merchants	payee id, name or website
allowed_instruments	the payment instrument
execution_window	when it happened
agent_key	the agent's key thumbprint

Unknown types are recorded and logged, not rejected. Verifiable Intent is still a draft.

Answer 1

within

Every constraint holds.

Illustrative example

Mandate	groceries, $150.00 per order
Payment	grocer, $84.20

Answer 2

outside

At least one constraint was broken. This raises a high-severity alert that names the amount and the limit.

Illustrative example

Mandate	groceries, $150.00 per order
Payment	grocer, $200.00

✕ Alert mandate_breach, high

Answer 3

not_evaluable

There's no valid mandate, or a constraint can't be checked from the data available.

It isn't a pass. It tells a reviewer the record can't answer the question.

Closed mandates

One payment, exact values.

A closed mandate covers one payment. We also check that its payee, amount and instrument equal those on the event. A difference is a finding.

Illustrative example

	In mandate	On event
Payee	supplier_a	supplier_b
Amount	$1,240.00	$1,240.00
Instrument	card_4421	card_4421

What a mandate does not do

A mandate is evidence of authority.

We report whether a payment stayed within it. We don't enforce it. Enforcement belongs to the network and your own controls, because we're not in the payment path.

docs.halvorai.com/concepts/mandates

Developer preview

